

Increase of ^{210}Po levels in human semen fluid after mussel ingestion.

Polonium-210 (^{210}Po) radioactive concentrations were determined in human semen fluid of vasectomized non-smoker volunteers. The ^{210}Po levels ranged from 0.10 to 0.39 mBq g⁻¹ (mean: 0.23 ± 0.08 mBq g⁻¹). This value decreased to 0.10 ± 0.02 mBq g⁻¹ (range from 0.07 to 0.13 mBq g⁻¹) after two weeks of a controlled diet, excluding fish and seafood. Then, volunteers ate during a single meal 200 g of the cooked mussel *Perna perna* L., and ^{210}Po levels were determined again, during ten days, in semen fluid samples collected every morning. Volunteers continued with the controlled diet and maintained sexual abstinence through the period of the experiment. A 300% increase of ^{210}Po level was observed the day following mussel consumption, with a later reduction, such that the level returned to near baseline by day 4. Copyright © 2011 Elsevier Ltd. All rights reserved.